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SHELBY TAUBER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Bridging a Painful Divide in Dallas
Andy Love and his daughter Avery at Halperin Park, built over Interstate 35E, which split a historic Black neighborhood. Page A11.

Trump Shields Tax Loophole For Businesses

By **JESSE DRUCKER** and **DYLAN FREEDMAN**
A year ago, the Trump administration withdrew from a global effort to curb offshore tax-dodging by multinational companies. That decision has been a huge gift to corporate America, enabling companies to avoid at least \$40 billion in income taxes since the beginning of 2025.

A New York Times review of securities filings from nearly 500 companies showed that they avoided taxes by attributing hundreds of billions of dollars in earnings to low- or no-tax foreign locales like Cyprus, Bermuda, Switzerland and the Cayman Islands. Often, corporations funneled the profits through subsidiaries in places where they had no employees, offices or customers.

Tax havens became more appealing after President Trump signed an order on his first day back in office withdrawing the United States from a 13-year international effort to end such schemes. The effort led dozens of countries to impose a minimum corporate tax and rules for pursuing companies using tax havens. After House Republicans passed legislation last year targeting some of those countries with a new tax, international officials agreed to exempt U.S. companies from much of the crackdown.

American Express avoided paying \$423 million in taxes last year using the island of Jersey. PayPal trimmed its taxes by nearly half during 2025 thanks to its units in Singapore. Stanley Black & Decker cut its bill by \$27 million — nearly one-third — using the island of Cyprus.

A favorite destination was the tiny Mediterranean island of Malta, where Abbott Laboratories, the pharmaceutical giant, has claimed all its global profits were earned by a subsidiary with no employees. Malta helped the company cut its tax bill by \$336 million last year, the filings show.

Companies making similar moves spanned nearly every sector of the economy: Walmart and Uber; Mastercard and Pepsi; Crocs and Merck; Honeywell and Cigna. To put the \$40 billion in taxes they avoided in perspective, it would be enough to triple the annual budget of the Federal Aviation

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The New York Restaurateur Who Loved Epstein

By **KIM SEVERSON**
When Jeffrey Epstein wanted his favorite Zweigle's Pop Open hot dogs ferried from his townhouse on the Upper East Side of Manhattan to his sprawling Zorro Ranch in New Mexico, he did what any exceedingly rich person might.

He had his staff reach out to a close friend with a private jet. Stephen Hanson, then head of a Manhattan restaurant empire that at its peak served more than 20,000 people a day at 25 theatrical, high-volume restaurants like Blue Water Grill, Dos Caminos

Owner of Popular Spots Helped With Women in Their Orbit

and Ruby Foo's, was happy to make the delivery himself.

“In the white freezer in downstairs kitchen of 71st street there are packages of frozen hot dogs,” Mr. Epstein's private chef emailed an assistant. “JE would like to have hot dogs for lunch tmrw and these are the new dogs he likes.”

There was one other favor Mr.

Epstein wanted on that August weekend in 2012. He asked Mr. Hanson to make room for a woman who would be bringing a wallet he'd left behind, according to documents the Department of Justice collected as it investigated Mr. Epstein. She was later paid settlements from funds established for Mr. Epstein's victims.

The Justice Department files attest to Mr. Epstein's transactional relationships with many powerful men. Billionaires like the Victoria's Secret magnate Les Wexner and the private equity investor Leon Black helped build his fortune. Boldfaced names like

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SHURAN HUANG FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A watch party last week at Madison Square Garden, the site of Game 3 of the N.B.A. finals Monday.

A President, a Mayor and the Kings of New York

This article is by **Jonah E. Bromwich**, **Dana Rubinstein** and **William K. Rashbaum**.

In any venue, President Trump and Mayor Zohran Mamdani of New York City might dominate the spotlight, especially if the two happened to be at the same place at the same time.

But on Monday, the two heavyweights from New York will be side attractions at best, watching with the rest of a sold-out Madison Square Garden as the city's pre-

With Knicks Near Title, Manic Scene Awaits

vailing megastars — the Knicks — return for Game 3 of the N.B.A. finals.

The team's success has transformed the energy of the city, whipping it into an irrepressible froth of orange and blue excitement, with each game at the Garden becoming a magnet for celeb-

rities, political leaders and superfans — both inside and outside the arena.

The Knicks are returning to the most famous basketball arena in the world having won 13 games in a row, the last four on the road, with a championship in reach for the first time in more than a half-century.

Monday will also be a homecoming of sorts for Mr. Trump, a native New Yorker whose last center-stage appearance at the

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Trump Claims Pledge by Iran That Isn't New

Nuclear Arms Forsworn Starting Decades Ago

By **MICHAEL CROWLEY**
WASHINGTON — More than two months of on-again, off-again peace talks have made little progress toward settling the U.S. war on Iran. But President Trump has lately claimed a major breakthrough.

“The one guarantee that I have to have is that there will be no nuclear weapons,” Mr. Trump said in an interview with his daughter-in-law Lara Trump on Fox News last month. Iran, he added, has “agreed to that, and it was very interesting.”

Mr. Trump emphasized the point again last Monday. “They’ve already agreed they’re not going to have a nuclear weapon,” he told a New York Post podcast. “That was one of the things they’ve had to agree, they’ve agreed to that. That was the big thing,” he said.

Mr. Trump has said the main reason he went to war on Feb. 28 was to prevent Iran from acquiring a nuclear weapon. An official White House fact sheet lists 74 occasions, dating to 2011, when Mr. Trump said that Iran must never have a nuclear weapon.

But Mr. Trump's boasts of an Iranian commitment have puzzled nuclear experts. The president appears to be claiming credit for something that is neither new nor, experts say, particularly meaningful.

“It's not much of a concession,” said Gary Samore, a veteran arms control expert who dealt with Iran as a National Security Council official in the Obama administration.

One reason is that Tehran has forsworn nuclear weapons for more than 50 years, insisting over and over that its nuclear program is only for peaceful purposes such as electricity and medicine. Its promises have come in the form of written pledges, verbal statements and even a religious ruling, or fatwa, from its supreme leader.

Another is that such a promise

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EAVESDROPPING Israel is an ally, but also a counterintelligence threat, U.S. reports show. PAGE A7

URANIUM Iran's stockpile is believed buried deep at several sites, beyond easy U.S. reach. PAGE A5

THE WEATHER
Today, cooler than recent days, dry, mostly sunny, high 78. **Tonight**, calm wind, clear, low 61. **Tomorrow**, warmer than average, sunny, high 84. Weather map is on Page B6.

IRAN LAUNCHES MISSILE ATTACK AGAINST ISRAEL

BARRAGE INTERCEPTED

Tehran Says Netanyahu Broke Cease-Fire by Bombing Beirut

This article is by **David M. Halbfinger**, **Katie Rogers** and **Aaron Boxerman**.

Iran attacked Israel with a limited number of ballistic missiles late Sunday after an Israeli attack in the outskirts of Beirut against Hezbollah, the Iranian-backed militant group. The attack raised the specter of a return to open conflict between Iran and Israel for the first time since a cease-fire paused the U.S.-Israeli war with Iran in early April.

The Israeli military said that it had intercepted all Iranian missiles in the first of two barrages and announced at around 11 p.m. local time that citizens were free to leave shelters. The government ordered schools to be closed nationwide on Monday as a precautionary measure.

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guards Corps said the missile barrages were a response to Israel's attack on Hezbollah. It said its acceptance of a cease-fire with the United States and Israel had been conditioned on a cease-fire on all fronts. “Tonight's operation was a warning, and if aggressions are repeated, the responses will be broader,” the Guards Corps said in a statement.

Israel did not immediately respond to the Iranian missile attack, but its military suggested it was eager to. “The Iranian terror regime committed a grave error,” Brig. Gen. Effie Defrin, spokesman for the Israeli military, said in a televised briefing. He said Iran was “trying to forge a new equation by launching directly at our territory” in response to Israeli action in Lebanon. “We will not allow that,” he said.

Earlier on Sunday, Israel said it had bombed a Hezbollah site on the southern outskirts of the Lebanese capital after the group attacked northern Israel.

Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, the Iranian Parliament speaker and chief negotiator in talks to end the war with the United States, said Israel's attack on Sunday on a neighborhood south of Beirut known as the Dahiya had turned “U.S. and Israeli bases and assets in the region into legitimate targets.”

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Kennedy Shows Little Interest In His Vast Health Care Duties

By **SHERYL GAY STOLBERG**
WASHINGTON — Shortly after the World Health Organization declared the Ebola outbreak in Africa a public health emergency, a reporter asked Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. if he was worried about the virus. Six Americans had already been exposed. His response was brief: “Yeah, we’re working on it.”

In the nearly three weeks since, as the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention imposed travel restrictions to keep the virus from coming to the United States, Mr. Kennedy has made no public comments about the spreading outbreak. He has received very few briefings about the virus from C.D.C. scientists, although he speaks daily to the acting director, according to people familiar with his response.

Mr. Kennedy's approach to the crisis reflects his broader management of the Department of Health and Human Services,



TIERNEY L. CROSS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Robert F. Kennedy Jr. focuses on his personal priorities.

which affects the health of 340 million Americans and provides health care to 40 percent of the population through Medicare and Medicaid.

Mr. Kennedy has shown little interest in managing the details of work in his department, according to multiple colleagues. Instead, they say, he is single-mindedly fo-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

A Sherpa's Mystery Ordeal

Dawa Sherpa survived six days before being found on Mount Everest. Did his employer abandon him? PAGE A4

Colombia, Soccer and Politics

A candidate endorsed by President Trump has been accused of co-opting the national team's jersey. PAGE A8

BUSINESS B1-5

Buying Reliable Used Gadgets

With a shortage of some components driving up costs of consumer electronics, refurbished devices are a good option, our columnist says. PAGE B1

A.I. Can Supercharge Hacking

Researchers showed how technology could be used to make a program to target any flaws in computers. PAGE B1

SPORTS D1-8

A Tennis Breakthrough

Alexander Zverev won at the French Open for his first Grand Slam singles championship. PAGE D3



ARTS C1-6

Making a Rom-Com Match

The Bronx-born Jennifer Lopez and the British comedian Brett Goldstein are more alike than you might think. PAGE C1

Bidding a Musical Farewell

Carter Brey, the New York Philharmonic's principal cellist for 30 years, is retiring from the orchestra soon. PAGE C1

NATIONAL A11-16

First Crisis for New Governor

Mikie Sherrill sent the New Jersey State Police outside an immigration detention center after U.S. officials said they would flood the area with armed agents. Not everyone approved. PAGE A13

Trump Looms Over Runoff

The president has not yet endorsed Representative Mike Collins or Derek Dooley, a former football coach, in the Georgia race to challenge Senator Jon Ossoff, a Democrat. PAGE A14

OPINION A18-19

Molly Jong-Fast

PAGE A19



OBITUARIES A17, 20

He Made Clouds From Wire

Alan Saret, a sculptor, created large, airy tangles that suggested tumbleweeds, nests or tulle. They also sometimes swayed. He was 81. PAGE A20

